unique rules of leasing. Leasing is primarily a lifestyle decision, not an economic one. Some simple questions to ask yourself before deciding to lease or buy are:

- Do you want to make a large down payment before driving off the car lot or do you have another use for the money? If you think your money could be more profitably invested in something other than a car (the stock market, for example), then a lease might make more sense.
- Are you comfortable with having to make a car payment every month or do you live for the day when your vehicle is paid for? Consumers accustomed to car payments are ideal candidates for leasing because most experts believe that the best way to lease is to turn a car in at the end of the contract and to start all over again.
- Do you do a lot of driving? Leases are not the right choice for people who put many miles on their cars. Most contracts impose limits of ten thousand to fifteen thousand miles per year. Any mileage over that amount is usually subject to a ten-cent to twenty-five-cent mile charge at the end of the lease.
- How long do you want to keep the automobile? If you plan to drive your car until it dies in your driveway, then you are better off purchasing it. Even if you know how to negotiate a lease that protects your interests, you will face a second round of talks when the lease expires, either to finance the remaining cost or to reduce it. It is simpler and the outcome is probably the same if you do all the negotiations at the time of the initial purchase.
- Are you prepared to stick with the lease for its entire term? Penalties for breaking a lease before it expires can be substantial. Remember that you are guaranteeing a payment, you are not buying a car. Consider it more like renting.